



Watch out for sharks!!

Google's project Expedition will take you through Great Barrier Reef using VR.
<http://dgit.in/VRexpedition>



Yahoo Mail fixed

Critical Yahoo bug that allowed hijackers to control account settings is fixed, feel safe?
<http://dgit.in/FixedYahoo>

Geek life

current payment systems. One advantage lies in not having to rely on banks or financial institutions for payments since you can transact from person to person for a lesser amount of transaction fees (1% compared to 3.5% currently in foreign exchange). The best advantage of Bitcoin that has caught everyone's attention is the blockchain technology it incorporates to remove counterfeiting. Although you can buy Bitcoins using your real money, you can generate Bitcoins by a method called mining. Bitcoins are mined by solving complex mathematical problems. Several portals around the world support payment through Bitcoins and all these payments are stored on a public ledger system which can be accessed by anyone to trace their Bitcoin transactions. Imagine the power of being able to identify and trace your previous payments and how powerful it would stand against any kind of fishy money-laundering business.

The current scenario of Bitcoin in India

As Bitcoin garnered popularity in other parts of the world, it saw interest among enthusiasts in India. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had issued a cautionary circular in late Dec 2013, showing concern over the use of "Virtual Currencies" or "Decentralised Digital Currency". The statement read, "The Reserve Bank of India has today cautioned the users, holders and traders of Virtual currencies (VCs), including Bitcoins, about the potential financial, operational, legal, customer protection and security related risks that they are exposing themselves to." Basically, it was a blanket statement over the use of virtual currencies, repeatedly mentioning Bitcoins, and they advised users and traders not to indulge in its usage. Their concern was justified since they were still exploring the concept of virtual currencies. After a few days since the release of this statement, the Enforcement Directorate of India raided the office of a Bitcoin trading website – buysellbit.co.in which was based in Ahmedabad. The raid was conducted on the premise of violating the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) rules of the country, not because of Bitcoins. The investigation revealed that

around 400 users were using the website and have recorded over 1000 transactions amounting to a few crores of rupees.

Later in 2014, we saw a Bitcoin real-time trading portal named BTCXIndia come into existence, working in full swing. But soon, in less than a year, BTCXIndia had to shut down operations by the end of May 2015 as their banking partners Kotak no longer wanted to serve Bitcoin businesses, according to their official statement. Coincidentally, during the same time, according to a report by CNBC (<http://dgit.in/KotakConcrn>), Uday Kotak expressed his concerns about the arrival of a disruptive technology in banking which could function without banks. Eventually, BTCXIndia shifted to another bank and are now back in operation. Due to the absence of any legal and regulatory measures from the RBI, BTCXIndia temporarily has set its own regulation policies on Anti-Money Laundering and validating customers.

The positive takeaway is that the RBI isn't completely rejecting the idea of virtual currencies. In an interview with Raghuram Rajan, Governor of the RBI, when asked about his views on Bitcoins, he confirmed that they are watching the evolution of these type of virtual currencies. He raised the issues faced by Bitcoin talking about security issues and the highly volatile nature of its value. He believes that eventually we are going to move towards a cashless society and reassured that they would consider using virtual currencies even if it meant losing money. Rajan's statements reflected on how open the RBI is to introduce new concepts of transaction. At the end of Dec 2015, RBI released a reassuring statement by endorsing blockchain technology and virtual currencies. They praised its potential of fighting counterfeiting, overcome the challenges faced by the

existing fiat currency system and also believe that it can bring major transformations in the current functioning state of financial markets, collateral identification and payments system. The main intention of RBI here is to promote the potential of technologies that will lead to reducing costs and increasing the efficiency.

Many Bitcoin companies have been cropping up lately which is again an indication to the rising popularity and future-sight for Bitcoin. Recently, a Bitcoin mobile wallet service called Zebpay received funding of \$1 million in VC funding. Zebpay is a rebranded buysellbit.co.in and this time they are getting serious about making it easier to buy and sell Bitcoins. A Bitcoin startup receiving funding is a positive sign that there is potential in the market this year.



The crypto-currency phenomenon is hitting India soon

Bitcoin mining as we all know isn't easy nor is it cheap. A lot has to be taken into account when it comes to opening up mining farms or just one mining machine. It takes a high degree of computing power now made easier with ASIC chips that are manufactured just for mining. Setting up only one mining machine would take a long time to solve the mathematical problems and generate Bitcoins. Hence, mining farms are set up with an array of machine mining Bitcoins. Such farms require a lot of electricity to run the machines and also cooling systems. Power isn't cheap in India and being the most important factor,